

Project XTC

Working Paper 010

Chapter 10 – Device Mode: Where the X-Touch Becomes an Instrument

Up to this point we've looked at the X-Touch as a mixer. Device Mode is where that changes. Instead of controlling tracks, the controller begins talking directly to the currently selected Bitwig device or plug-in.

One Device at a Time

DrivenByMoss always concentrates on the device that currently has the focus in Bitwig. Select a different track or choose another device in the device chain and the X-Touch reconfigures itself almost instantly. The V-Pots, scribble strips and LED rings all update to describe the newly selected parameters.

Remote Controls First

Bitwig's Remote Controls are the secret weapon of Device Mode. Rather than exposing hundreds of parameters, they present the eight most useful controls for performance. This makes the X-Touch feel less like a generic MIDI controller and more like a purpose-built hardware front panel.

Aha!

Think of Remote Controls as creating your own hardware synthesiser. Every time you carefully choose the eight parameters that matter most, you're designing the front panel that the X-Touch will present to you.

Workflow Example

Load Polymer. Map the first Remote Controls to Cutoff, Resonance, Envelope Amount, Drive, Oscillator Shape and the remaining parameters you use most often. Now step away from the mouse and perform the sound entirely from the X-Touch. The controller becomes an expressive instrument rather than a collection of knobs.

Field Note #003

Many third-party plug-ins expose hundreds or even thousands of automatable parameters. Don't try to control them all. Invest a few minutes creating sensible Remote Controls and the X-Touch becomes dramatically easier—and far more enjoyable—to use.

Looking Ahead

The next working paper explores Browser Mode, where DrivenByMoss allows you to search, audition and load sounds without constantly reaching for the computer keyboard.